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How (and why) to make the perfect Super Shake. [Infographic]

Delicious liquid meals that save time, nourish and satisfy.

By [John Berardi, PhD, CSCS](#)

Maybe you need a quick breakfast before the morning commute, or an energy-replenishing lunch you can eat on your way from gym to meeting.

Something you can tote in the car or a knapsack. Something that doesn't require cutlery, napkins, or a fancy tablecloth.

Something healthy. Something packed full of nutrients — fruits and vegetables, lean protein, and healthy fats. And something *easy*.

Meet the Super Shake.

It's a meal in a glass — high-quality liquid nutrition that gives you everything you need in a convenient, portable, delicious package.

[Print this](#) and stick this to your fridge — then blend, sip, and repeat.

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THE SUPER SHAKE GUIDE: TURN YOUR BORING PROTEIN SMOOTHIE INTO A SUPER SHAKE

These unique, nutrient-packed shakes can serve as excellent meal replacements when you're short on time.

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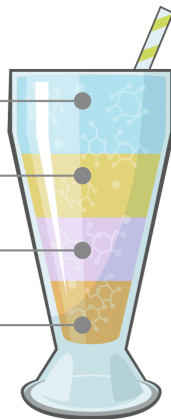


JUICE-BAR SHAKES VS. SUPER SHAKES



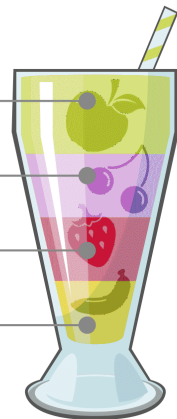
JUICE-BAR SHAKES

- Contain high levels of sugar
- Include low-quality protein sources
- Rely heavily on processed ingredients
- Use too many artificial components



SUPER SHAKES

- Contain minimal sugar and artificial ingredients
- Use high-quality protein sources
- Include whole fruits and vegetables
- Provide fiber and healthy fats



START WITH A GOOD BLENDER

Since your Super Shakes will use whole foods and some frozen ingredients, you'll need a powerful machine. Here are two good options.



MAGIC BULLET

Good blender for everyday use

PRICE

under \$50

POWER

250 Watts

CAPACITY

19 oz

May wear out after only a few months

VITAMIX

The Rolls Royce of blenders

PRICE

over \$300

POWER

1400 Watts

CAPACITY

64 oz

Comes with a minimum 5-year warranty



STEPS TO MAKING YOUR SUPER SHAKE

Go through the steps below, selecting one or two items from each category.

STEP 1: PICK A LIQUID

Less liquid = thick shakes
More liquid = thin shakes

4-8 oz

is a good starting
point for each serving.



- Water
- Almond milk (unsweetened)
- Cow's milk
- Soy milk (unsweetened)
- Hemp milk (unsweetened)
- Iced green tea

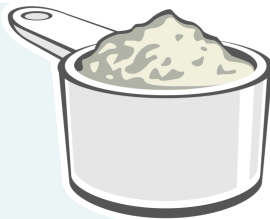
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STEP 2: PICK A PROTEIN POWDER

25-50 g

1-2 scoops should
be sufficient for
each serving.



- Whey protein
- Casein protein
- Rice protein
- Pea protein
- Hemp protein
- Other proteins or protein blend

Find a protein supplement that tastes good and digests well.

STEP 3: PICK A VEGGIE

1-2 handfuls

Use raw or
roasted veggies.



- Dark leafy greens:
Spinach / Swiss chard / kale
- Pumpkin / sweet potato
- Beets / beet greens
- Cucumber / celery
- Powdered greens supplement

Spinach works well in any Super Shake since it's virtually undetectable.

Pair canned or roasted pumpkin with vanilla.

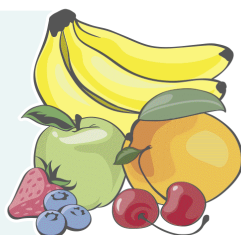
Try pairing peeled, roasted beets with chocolate.

When including celery or cucumber, reduce the amount of liquid you add.

STEP 4: PICK A FRUIT

1-2 handfuls

You can use fresh
or frozen fruit.



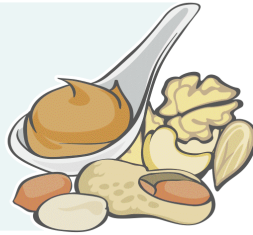
- Apples
- Bananas
- Berries
- Cherries
- Dates
- Pineapple / mango
- Powdered fruit supplement

Toss in half a banana to give the shake excellent texture.

Dates are very sweet. Make sure to get rid of the pit first.
Apples provide sweet and tart notes. Simply remove the core and slice.

STEP 5: PICK A HEALTHY FAT

1-2 thumb -
sized portions
should be sufficient
for each serving.



- Walnuts
- Flax, hemp, chia seeds
- Cashews
- Almonds
- Peanut and nut butters

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When blended well, nuts and seeds offer a nice, rich consistency.

STEP 6: PICK A TOPPER

Try cinnamon with vanilla
and pumpkin.
Add oats if you need extra carbs.
Incorporate yogurt if you want more
protein and a smoother texture.
With toppers, a little goes a long way.



- Coconut
- Cacao nibs / dark chocolate
- Yogurt
- Oats / granola
- Cinnamon
- Ice (if using fresh fruit)

RECIPES FROM THE PROS

Here's the original
Super Shake, courtesy of
PN co-founder Dr. John Berardi

½ cup plain Greek yogurt

2 thumb-sized portions
of mixed nuts

1 cupped handful
of frozen mixed berries

1 handful of spinach
and 1 scoop powdered
greens supplement

2 scoops of vanilla
milk protein blend

4 ounces water

Here's another favorite
Super Shake, courtesy of
PN coach Ryan Andrews

A few sprinkles of
coconut and 5 ice cubes

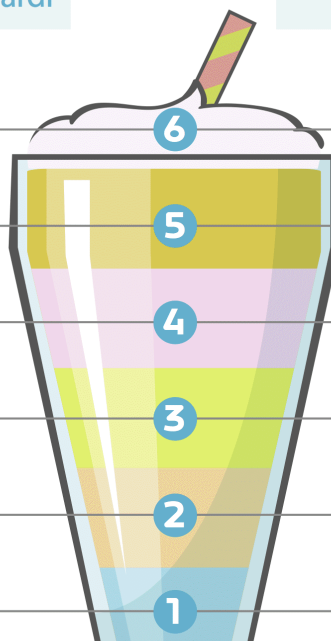
2 thumb-sized
portions of walnuts

Half a frozen banana
and 2 pitted dates

2 kale leaves and
1 scoop of powdered
greens supplement

2 scoops of plain
pea protein powder

4 ounces water





Just remember: Not all of the steps are mandatory. Don't want a topper? Leave it out. Want extra veggies? Add 'em in. Trying to reduce calories? Change the portion sizes.

MIX AND MATCH TO FIND THE PERFECT SUPER SHAKE FOR YOU.

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For the full article explaining this infographic:
<http://www.precisionnutrition.com/super-shake-creation>



Precision Nutrition

Happy blending!

Want to take these tips everywhere? [Click here](#) for a fully printable version of this infographic.

Want more delicious Super Shake ideas? [Click here to download our Super Shake Guide](#), a beautiful booklet with recipes, photos, and more.

Love what you learned? For a complete explanation of this infographic, check out our accompanying article: [The Super Shake Guide: Turn your boring protein smoothie into a Super Shake](#).

Join 150,000+ people who've transformed their health with PN Coaching.

Most people *know* that regular movement, eating well, sleep, and stress management are important for looking and feeling better. The challenge is making it all work in the middle of real life—work, family, stress, and everything else that gets in the way.

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Over the past two decades, [PN Coaching](#) has helped more than 150,000 clients **lose fat, get stronger, and improve their physical and mental health**—for the long-term. Our habit-based approach is backed by peer-reviewed research, trusted by professional athletes and elite sports teams, and recognized by the 175,000+ health professionals who've learned it through our [certification programs](#).

Knowing what to do and actually doing it are two different things.

Work 1-to-1 with a PN coach on a plan built around your real life.

- ✓ Biweekly video calls to track your progress
- ✓ In-app messaging between sessions
- ✓ A personalized plan that adjusts as your life does



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